SpeechGeek

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One of our goals in publishing **SpeechGeek** is to introduce the forensic world to new and talented writers. Traditional publishers often neglect promising writers. Other publishers are often clueless as to the needs of forensics performers. The material found in **SpeechGeek** is written by veteran and new forensic students and coaches. We strive to provide a product that is fresh and challenges the conventions of what makes a great performance. The most rewarding part of this process is that the material is left in your hands to make the final decision. You get to explore the emotions, characters, and stories. We may provide the material, but the end result is completely up to you. **Season Three starts here and what a season it will be!**

Corey Alderdice
Publisher

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Pipe Dreams

by Andy Birge

NARR. In a time long past, there once lived a man and his brother with the ability to make right where there was once wrong, peace where there was chaos, and nothing where there was once spaghetti. These that I speak of are the brothers Mario...

LUIGI. Wait! Why does it have to be all about Mario? Mario....Mario...Mario...

NARR. But isn't your last name Mario?

LUIGI. Well...yeah, but I mean...WHAT KIND OF NAME IS MARIO MARIO ANYWAY? (*turns away sobbing*)

(Toadstool wanders into the room.)

TOAD. Hhhheeey guys...you got any candy? (*staggers*)

LUIGI. What's up Toadstool? Look at me. Let me see your eyes. Are you drunk again?

TOAD. Yeah. So?

LUIGI. SO, it's 9:30 in the morning.

TOAD. Hey, let me tell you something, I love you man...No, I mean it...I really love you man...(*mumbles off*)

LUIGI. Have you paid the utilities yet?

NARR. Like I was saying before, the Mario Brothers have revolutionized our world as well as the Mushroom Kingdom. I am here today with Luigi Mario, faithful sidekick and brother to the world famous Mario Mario. So, Luigi, I see that you have gained a few pounds since we last saw you. What happened?

LUIGI. Well, mainly, I was tired of maintaining my image. After our life story was made into a movie, my reputation was ruined. I attribute the fall of my career to John Leguizamo. Hollywood wanted to make me seem like the pansy sidekick. Back in the day, I ran the game.

NARR. So, what have you and the crew been up to over the past fifteen years?

LUIGI. Well, Mario and I don't speak much since the plumbing business went down the drain. No pun intended. Since he went on the Atkin's diet, he thinks he's too good for me, rolling in royalties and spaghetti sauce. He doesn't eat the noodles anymore, though—or the mushrooms.

NARR. No mushrooms?

LUIGI. Well, the mushrooms from the Kingdom are *really* high in carbs. Haven't you seen that fool? He's emaciated, but he still has the best parties, I'll give him that. Everyone's there...me and Toad, the Princess, all the goombas, Bowser...

NARR. Bowser?

LUIGI. Oh, Bowser gave up his life of crime long ago when he married. It's shunned upon and everything--marrying outside of the game. It's an issue to some, but I don't care.

(Cut to interview with Bowser, AKA King Koopa.)

BOWSER. There is only one way. We must find the light that lies within us in order to find our ultimate purpose. Isn't that right, honey?

WIFE. Of course, Bowzie.

NARR. So tell me, how did you meet?

BOWSER. Well, one day I was at the bottom of a castle throwing fireballs at tourists and I realized I was missing something. A hole that no fireball could fill: the hole of true love. In the past, every woman I abducted was rescued, but this time, I knew she would rescue me.

NARR. So....*how* did you meet?

The General Salute

by Jace Lux and Matthew Gerbig

DAVID. **late 20's / early 30's**
LUKE. **late 20's / early 30's**

-teaser-

DAVID. (*kneeling down, talking to little boy).* First day of school big guy... you nervous? Don't be. Just remember, if you need anything, call us. You're going to meet so many new friends Jeff. And you're going to learn a lot too. Kindergarten is so much fun. I wish I could go with you because I remember how much fun that was. Just go easy on all those little girls, alright buddy? Okay...

LUKE. *(appears, David stands up) Is my son ready?*

DAVID. *Yeah, I was just telling him about all the fun he's going to have and the friends he's-*

LUKE. (*cuts him off*) C'mon, Jeff. We need to go. (*David leaves.*) Well private, you ready? (*adjusts Jeff's hat*) Remember to stand up straight and be proud. Be polite, look people in their eyes and if you have any problems, you call me. Have fun. Now let me see that salute. No, no, make sure your fingers are straight and your wrist is tight. Like this (*he salutes his son*). There you go. You're ready. Knock 'em dead private.

-scene change-

LUKE. How do you talk to a five year old about divorce? How do you let him know that it's not his fault...that things between his mother and I just didn't work out. That's all there is to it. I wish that I could explain to him that my job with the military requires me to be gone... a lot. And that's what the problem was. I was just never around for her...or for him. I wish I could explain to him that the new guy his mom is married to is not his father. I will always be his father.

DAVID. I love that boy. He's one of the greatest joys I have ever come into contact with. But how do I, as his stepfather, compare to his real father? That man is one of the most successful generals ever to serve this country, and Jeff has him on a pedestal. Hell, I have him on a pedestal. And I don't want to be up there with him, I just want Jeff to understand my role in his life.

-scene change-

LUKE. (*kneeling, talking to son. Looking through son's drawings*) Oh, these are good, private. You've got some real artistic ability here. Can I have this one? (*David walks in the room.*) Alright Jeff, I'm going to pick you up for school again tomorrow morning. Why don't you go hang these drawings on the refrigerator. Hey. (*salutes him.*)

DAVID. How did he do?

LUKE. Oh he was fine.

DAVID. Yeah, I knew he would be. You know that kid is something else. He just gets along so well with everyone. And he can really adapt to new situations.

LUKE. Yeah. Well he's done a lot of that lately.

DAVID. Why, don't forget about his youth league basketball game tomorrow. I know he's gonna want you there. It's at seven in the...

LUKE. I know when the game is, David. I'll be there. I gotta run. Tell Susan hello.

DAVID. Luke, I know this is awkward for everyone, but I'm really trying to make this work.

LUKE. Well stop trying. My only concern is Jeffrey. I don't care about being your friend and I don't need to make peace with Susan. So whatever it is you're trying to make work... don't bother.

-scene change-

(*David is on the basketball court warming the kids up, and Luke is behind him, shuffling through the stands to his seat)*

DAVID. Come on Steve, dunk it (*lifts boy above his head*) 'atta boy! Your turn Ryan! (*lifts boy above his head*). You can't get past me. (in an announcer voice) And Jason has the ball, he head fakes, pivots, drives for the layup, this could be the game folks. It's good, Bulls win!!!! OK guys, hustle up, pull it in. Go Lizards on three. One, two, three, Gooo Lizards!!!.

(The game begins. David is ad-lib cheering from the sidelines and Luke is doing the same from the stands.)

LUKE. Come on private! Go... (*ad lib)*

DAVID. Come on Jeff! (*ad lib*) Take it to the lane. That's it. Go son! *(*all action stops. Luke has a look of disbelief on his face. He stands and walks up to David.*)*

LUKE. That boy is not your son. He is not your fucking son. Look in a mirror. You're nothing alike. He is not your fucking son!

-scene change-

(Later that evening. Luke hears a knock on his door. He opens it, and it's David.)

LUKE. You want something?

DAVID. Yeah, can I come in?

LUKE. It's a free country.

DAVID. Luke, I'm sorry. I didn't mean for it to come out like that. I mean, I did, but not like it sounded. I'm not trying to take your place. I don't want to take your place. The fact of the matter is that I am a part of Jeff's life now.

LUKE. (*interrupts him*) Do you think this has been easy for me? I mean, a divorce is enough to deal with, but now I have to share my son with a man who I don't even like? A fucking....a black man.

DAVID. And why is that Luke? What is it you have against me?

LUKE. My image, for one. Do you honestly think that his friends don't wonder why he's the only one to show up to a school function with a black man?

DAVID. His friends are five years old! Besides, things have changed!

LUKE. Not enough! I hear the same shit today I heard fifty years ago. Things don't change that much. Things just...slightly transition.

DAVID. This hasn't been easy for me either you ignorant son of a bitch!

LUKE. Excuse-

DAVID. Coming into a new family, feeling like I'm on someone else's territory, always feeling like I will never live up to you. But the simple fact is, and there's no getting around this, is that it's not about you and I. We don't have to like each other, but we both have to love that little boy, and he has to love both of us. And you're the one who's making that difficult for him. Would you rather it be someone who doesn't even give a damn?

LUKE. Don't you ever come into my home and insult me like that! This is not your place to question me. This is my home, remember? My family.

DAVID. Not anymore.

LUKE. Don't you ever- (*beat*) Do you know that next week I'm being sent to a country whose location I can't even disclose to you? Or how about

this. I'll be there for at least six months, quite possibly a lot longer, and that means at least six months away from the thing that makes me the happiest in my life. Six months without Jeff. And do you have any idea how much that fucking hurts? So you put on a uniform and risk your life for this country and sacrifice seeing Jeffrey, and then you talk to me about being difficult.

DAVID. Luke, I had no idea. (*a long beat*)

LUKE. *(takes a deep breath*) The only thing that I know for sure is that whether you want to or not, for the next six months you're going to have to take my place. You're going to be his father. And whether or not I like it, it's the only choice I have. *(long beat)*

DAVID. Do you think I'm up to it?

LUKE. I don't know. Do you?

DAVID. I hope so. *(long beat. Luke puts his hand up first, and the two shake hands.)*

-scene change-

LUKE. (both are kneeling down, talking to son) I'll be coming back soon. You keep getting good grades in school. And remember what I told you about being polite.

DAVID. Your dad will be home before you can say hippopotamus. Alright, maybe not that fast, but before you know it.

LUKE. And private, you be sure to stand up straight and don't give David any trouble. I don't want him to have to call me.

DAVID. Yeah, and I'll do it too! *(the men stand and talk to each other.)*

DAVID. You take care of yourself.

LUKE. I will. You too, David. (*Luke kneels down to son again*.) You take care of your mom, private. And I want you to be sure to send me some of those drawings you do in school. And you better write to me all the time, big guy. (*Jeff's crying. Luke grabs his chin*.) Hey, it'll be alright. I'll be back soon. Let me see that salute. (*He nods his head and salutes. He stands up and grabs Jeff's hand. David grabs Jeff's other hand, and they stand there with the boy between them for a moment*.)